

CLOUDKART

API Setup Guide

Technical Support Knowledge Base

Covers generating API keys, authenticating requests, rate limits, error handling, webhooks, and official client libraries for developers integrating with CloudKart.

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1. Overview

The CloudKart API allows Pro and Enterprise customers to programmatically manage projects, orders, and account data. This guide walks through generating credentials, making the first authenticated request, and understanding rate limits and error handling. It is the primary technical reference for any developer-facing support question about the API.

Before You Begin

API access requires a Pro or Enterprise plan. Starter and Plus accounts can view API documentation but cannot generate live API keys until upgrading.

The CloudKart API follows RESTful conventions: resources are addressed by predictable URL paths, all request and response bodies are JSON, and standard HTTP verbs (GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE) are used throughout. Developers familiar with any REST API will find the CloudKart API behaves as expected in terms of pagination, filtering, and error structures.

Worked Examples

Scenario: A Starter plan customer asks how to get started with the API.

Resolution: Explain they need to upgrade to Pro to generate live keys; share the API docs link for reading ahead while on Starter.

Scenario: Developer asks whether the API supports GraphQL.

Resolution: No — CloudKart's API is REST-only at this time; GraphQL is not available.

2. Generating API Keys

API keys authenticate every request made to the CloudKart API. Each account can maintain multiple keys, useful for separating staging and production environments.

- 1 Go to Account Settings > Developer > API Keys.
- 2 Click **Generate New Key** and choose an environment label such as 'production' or 'staging'.
- 3 Copy the generated key immediately — for security, the full key is shown only once and cannot be retrieved again after leaving the page.
- 4 Store the key in a secrets manager or environment variable. Never hard-code API keys directly into source code or commit them to version control.

Keys can be revoked at any time from the same page. Revoking a key takes effect within 60 seconds and immediately invalidates any in-flight requests using that key. Customers managing multiple environments should create separate keys per environment and rotate them on a schedule aligned with their organization's security policy — CloudKart does not enforce key rotation but recommends it.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Developer accidentally committed their API key to a public GitHub repo.

Resolution: Revoke the exposed key immediately from Account Settings > Developer > API Keys, then generate a new one. Advise using GitHub secret scanning alerts going forward.

Scenario: Developer wants separate keys for their CI pipeline and production app.

Resolution: Create two keys with descriptive labels ('ci-pipeline', 'production'); this allows granular revocation if one environment is compromised.

3. Making Your First Request

Every API request must include the key in the Authorization header using the Bearer scheme. Requests without a valid key, or with a revoked key, return 401.

```
curl -X GET "https://api.cloudkart.com/v1/projects" \  
  -H "Authorization: Bearer YOUR_API_KEY" \  
  -H "Content-Type: application/json"
```

A successful response returns HTTP 200 with a JSON body listing the authenticated account's projects. The response includes pagination metadata ('page', 'has_more') for collections that may span multiple pages.

```
{"data":[{"id":"proj_8a21","name":"Inventory  
Sync","status":"active"}], "page":1, "has_more":false}
```

Pagination is cursor-based for most collection endpoints. When 'has_more' is true, pass the 'starting_after' parameter with the last record's ID in the next request rather than incrementing a page number. This approach is more stable under concurrent data changes.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Developer gets 200 but the response 'data' array is empty.

Resolution: The account has no resources matching the query; this is not an error. Check whether the correct account's key is being used.

Scenario: Developer asks how to fetch orders beyond the first page.

Resolution: Use 'starting_after' with the last order's ID from the current response, and repeat until 'has_more' is false.

4. Rate Limits

API requests are rate-limited per key to keep the platform stable for all customers. Limits vary by plan and reset on a rolling one-minute window.

Plan	Requests / Minute	Burst Allowance
Pro	120	20 extra requests for short bursts
Enterprise (default)	600	100 extra requests for short bursts
Enterprise (custom)	Negotiated	Defined in contract

When a key exceeds its rate limit, the API returns HTTP 429 Too Many Requests along with a Retry-After header indicating how many seconds to wait before retrying. Well-behaved clients should implement exponential backoff rather than retrying immediately — polling in a tight loop after a 429 will only extend the lockout period.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Developer getting 429 errors despite what seems like light usage.

Resolution: Check whether multiple services share the same API key — the rate limit is per key, not per service. Also confirm the account plan; downgraded accounts inherit the lower limit silently.

Scenario: Enterprise customer needs more than 600 requests/minute.

Resolution: Route to the Sales team for a custom rate limit negotiation as part of their Enterprise contract; standard plans cannot exceed the published limits.

5. Error Codes and Handling

The API uses standard HTTP status codes along with a structured JSON error body to help identify the cause of a failed request quickly.

HTTP Status	Meaning	Common Cause
400	Bad Request	Malformed JSON or missing required field
401	Unauthorized	Missing, invalid, or revoked API key
403	Forbidden	Key valid but lacks permission for this resource
404	Not Found	Resource ID does not exist or was deleted
429	Too Many Requests	Rate limit exceeded
500	Internal Server Error	Unexpected server-side failure; safe to retry

All error responses include an 'error' object in the JSON body with a 'code' field (machine-readable) and a 'message' field (human-readable). Developers should branch on the 'code' field in their error-handling logic, not on the message text, since messages may be translated or updated.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Developer getting 403 even though they think they have the right key.

Resolution: 403 means the key is valid but lacks scope for this resource — check if a restricted key was generated; some keys are scoped to read-only.

Scenario: Developer getting intermittent 500 errors during heavy load.

Resolution: 500s are safe to retry with backoff; if they persist beyond a few minutes, check the CloudKart Status Page and escalate with tag tech-api-500 if needed.

6. Setting Up Webhooks

For real-time updates, the API supports webhooks instead of polling. Webhooks are useful for syncing order status changes or account events into an external system without repeatedly querying the API.

- 1 Go to Account Settings > Developer > Webhooks and click **Add Endpoint**.
- 2 Enter a publicly reachable HTTPS URL that will receive POST requests.
- 3 Select which events to subscribe to, such as order.shipped or subscription.renewed.
- 4 CloudKart sends a test ping; the endpoint must respond HTTP 200 within 5 seconds for the webhook to be activated.

Tip

Verify webhook authenticity using the signature included in the X-CloudKart-Signature header before trusting the payload, especially for endpoints that trigger billing or fulfillment actions.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Developer's webhook endpoint isn't being activated after setup.

Resolution: The test ping likely timed out or returned a non-200 status; check that the endpoint is publicly reachable and responds within 5 seconds.

Scenario: Developer asks if webhooks retry on failure.

Resolution: Yes — CloudKart retries failed webhook deliveries up to 5 times with exponential backoff; after 5 failures the webhook is disabled and the developer is emailed.

7. Official Client Libraries

CloudKart maintains official client libraries for several languages to reduce boilerplate around authentication, retries, and pagination.

- **Python:** `pip install cloudkart-sdk`
- **Node.js:** `npm install @cloudkart/sdk`
- **Ruby:** `gem install cloudkart`
- **Go:** `go get github.com/cloudkart/sdk-go`

Community-maintained libraries exist for other languages but are not officially supported; issues with them should be redirected to their respective repositories rather than CloudKart support. The official SDKs handle pagination, rate-limit backoff, and request signing automatically, so they are strongly preferred for new integrations.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Python developer asks how to install the SDK.

Resolution: `pip install cloudkart-sdk` — the SDK auto-reads the `CLOUDKART_API_KEY` env var so no explicit key-passing is required in most usage.

Scenario: Developer uses PHP and asks for a PHP SDK.

Resolution: No official PHP SDK exists; direct them to the REST API directly or to community libraries, clarifying that CloudKart support can't debug community library issues.

8. Common API Setup Issues

This section addresses the API setup issues most frequently raised in support.

Q: My key worked yesterday but now returns 401.

A: Check whether the key was rotated or revoked, which can happen automatically if CloudKart's security scanner detects the key in a public repository. Revoked-for-security keys are listed under Developer > API Keys > Revoked with a reason code.

Q: I keep getting 429 errors even with normal usage.

A: Confirm the account's actual plan tier matches the assumed rate limit; a downgraded account silently inherits the lower limit. Also check whether multiple services share the same API key, dividing the limit between them.

Worked Examples

Scenario: Developer's staging environment suddenly returns 401 with no code changes.

Resolution: Most likely the staging key was auto-revoked for security (e.g., found in a public repo or CI log); check the Revoked tab and generate a new key.

Scenario: Developer's webhook events stopped arriving with no obvious cause.

Resolution: Check the webhook's delivery log in Account Settings > Developer > Webhooks — if 5 consecutive failures occurred, the webhook may have been auto-disabled.

9. Quick Reference: API Triage

This quick reference covers the most common API-related support scenarios and their first diagnostic steps, formatted for rapid triage.

Symptom	Most Likely Cause	First Step
401 Unauthorized	Key missing, revoked, or malformed	Check key in Developer > API Keys
403 Forbidden	Key valid but scoped read-only	Check key permissions or generate new key
429 Too Many Requests	Rate limit hit	Check requests/minute vs plan limit; implement backoff
400 Bad Request	Malformed JSON or missing field	Validate request body against API docs
Webhook not triggering	Endpoint not responding within 5s	Check endpoint public accessibility and response time
SDK install fails	Network or package manager issue	Check firewall; try pip with --trusted-host flag

Worked Examples

Scenario: Developer's requests work in curl but fail in their Python SDK.

Resolution: Compare the raw request headers between curl and the SDK output; often the SDK version is outdated and uses a deprecated auth header format.

Scenario: Webhook events arrive but the payload signature check fails.

Resolution: Ensure the raw request body (not parsed JSON) is used for signature verification; parsing and re-serialising before checking will break the HMAC.

Appendix A: API Base URLs

Base URLs for CloudKart API environments.

Environment	Base URL
Production	https://api.cloudkart.com/v1
Staging (Enterprise only)	https://api-staging.cloudkart.com/v1